



Imagine a snake with a body so brightly colored, it looks like it's wearing a party costume! This is the Eastern Coral Snake, a small, thin snake with a head that barely stands out from its body. Its skin is covered with a pattern of red, yellow, and black bands that make it one of the most recognizable snakes in the world. But don't let its festive look fool you, this snake has a serious side too.

Speaking of serious, when it comes to mealtime, the Eastern Coral Snake is all business. Its favorite foods are small lizards and other snakes, which it catches using its short, fixed front fangs. The Eastern Coral Snake is a connoisseur of the 'grab-and-hold' style of dining, which means it holds onto its food while injecting it with venom. Even though this might sound scary, it is just part of how the Eastern Coral Snake survives in the wild.

This wild habitat of theirs is mostly in the southeastern United States. They like to live in forested or marshy areas where they can hide under leaf litter or in burrows. Eastern Coral Snakes are oviparous, which means they lay eggs, with the babies, called hatchlings, born fully formed. These hatchlings grow into adults who shed their skin several times a year, a process known as molting.



Now, you might be thinking, 'Do Eastern Coral Snakes and humans get along?' Well, they are shy and prefer to avoid humans, but if they feel threatened, they can bite to defend themselves. Their venom is very potent, but bites are rare because these snakes would rather hide or run away. In nature, every creature has its place, and for the Eastern Coral Snake, that place is being a quiet, colorful part of the world's amazing biodiversity.



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What do Eastern Coral Snakes do several times a year?
A. Shed their skin
B. Grow new fangs
C. Change their color
D. Hibernate
- 2) Where can Eastern Coral Snakes be found?
A. In the mountains of Asia.
B. In the rainforests of South America.
C. In the deserts of Africa.
D. In the southeastern United States.
- 3) Where in their habitat do Eastern Coral Snakes like to hide?
A. Under leaf litter or in burrows
B. In tree branches or in bird nests
C. In water or in swampy areas
D. Under rocks or in caves
- 4) How does a bite from an eastern coral snake affect humans?
A. It is very dangerous.
B. It is painless.
C. Coral snakes do not bite.
D. It causes temporary dizziness.
- 5) What is the name for the process in which Eastern Coral Snakes remove old skin?
A. Peeling
B. Exfoliating
C. Shedding
D. Molting
- 6) What is another term for the babies of Eastern Coral Snakes?
A. Hatchlings.
B. Fry.
C. Pups.
D. Larvae.
- 7) What color are the bands on the skin of the Eastern Coral Snake?
A. Red, yellow, and black
B. Orange, black, and white
C. Red, white, and blue
D. Blue, green, and yellow
- 8) What technique does the Eastern Coral Snake use to eat its food?
A. Hide and ambush
B. Stalk and pounce
C. Grab and hold
D. Chase and conquer
- 9) What is the Eastern Coral Snake's favorite food?
A. Insects like spiders and ants.
B. Small lizards and other snakes.
C. Birds and their eggs.
D. Nuts and seeds.
- 10) How does the Eastern Coral Snake catch its food?
A. By swallowing it whole.
B. Using its short, fixed front fangs.
C. By using its long, sharp teeth.
D. By constricting its prey.
- 11) What areas do Eastern Coral Snakes prefer for their habitat?
A. Mountainous areas
B. Forested or marshy areas
C. Urban areas
D. Desert areas
- 12) Are eastern coral snakes aggressive towards humans?
A. Yes, they are often aggressive towards humans.
B. Only the males are aggressive
C. Only the females are aggressive
D. No, they are shy and prefer to avoid humans.



- 13) Why are bites from Eastern Coral Snakes rare?
- A. These snakes would rather hide or run away
 - B. These snakes have poor aim
 - C. These snakes are friendly and prefer not to bite
 - D. These snakes lose their fangs with age

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 14) "Did you know we use our fangs to grab and hold our food while injecting it with venom?"
- 15) "You'll typically find me in icy, cold regions. I adore the snow!"
- 16) "I enjoy eating a diet that mainly consists of fruits and vegetables."
- 17) "Once I grow into an adult, I never shed my skin again!"
- 18) "You could spot us from a mile away with our bright red, yellow, and black stripes."
- 19) "When we are hungry, we like to munch on small lizards and, believe it or not, other snakes!"
- 20) "I prefer living on tree tops."
- 21) "I give live birth to my little ones. They come out wriggling and ready to explore the world."
- 22) "I have the mildest venom among snakes, harmless to humans!"
- 23) "Our babies, called hatchlings, are already fully formed when they are born."
- 24) "My venom isn't that powerful. A bite from me is similar to a bee sting."
- 25) "Even though our venom is potent, we hardly ever bite humans because we prefer to hide or run away."
- 26) "I have large, retractable fangs that I use to catch my food."

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 27) Eastern Coral Snakes shed their skin several times a year.
- 28) It's interesting to watch an Eastern Coral Snake shed its skin.
- 29) Eastern Coral Snakes prefer to hide under leaf litter or in burrows.
- 30) Eastern Coral Snakes are beautiful creatures with their vibrant red, yellow, and black bands.
- 31) Eastern Coral Snakes can be found in the southeastern part of the United States.
- 32) It is disgusting that Eastern Coral Snakes will eat other snakes.
- 33) Eastern Coral Snakes give birth to live young instead of laying eggs.
- 34) Eastern Coral Snakes mostly live in forested or marshy areas.
- 35) It's impressive how the Eastern Coral Snake can hold its food and inject venom at the same time.
- 36) It is surprising that the Eastern Coral Snake would rather hide or run away than bite humans.

Determine if the statement is true or false.

- 37) Eastern Coral Snakes are mostly found in the southeastern United States.
- 38) Eastern Coral Snakes live in very tall trees in the rainforest.
- 39) Eastern Coral Snakes live in forested or marshy areas.
- 40) Eastern Coral Snakes are found in the northern United States.
- 41) Eastern Coral Snakes shed their skin every year.
- 42) Eastern Coral Snakes live in deserts.



- 43) Eastern Coral Snakes are very aggressive and seek out humans to bite.
- 44) Eastern Coral Snakes eat only plants.
- 45) Eastern Coral Snakes prefer to avoid humans.
- 46) Eastern Coral Snakes lay eggs.

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 47) Eastern coral snakes are great climbers and can be found in trees.
- 48) Can eastern coral snakes swim?
- 49) Eastern coral snakes are venomous.
- 50) Eastern coral snakes have red, yellow, and black colored bands on their bodies.
- 51) How do eastern coral snakes protect themselves?
- 52) Where do eastern coral snakes live?



Eastern Coral Snake

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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|-----|--------------|-----|----------------------|-----|----------------------|
| 1. | <u>A</u> | 26. | <u>Not</u> | 51. | <u>interrogative</u> |
| 2. | <u>D</u> | 27. | <u>fact</u> | 52. | <u>interrogative</u> |
| 3. | <u>A</u> | 28. | <u>opinion</u> | | |
| 4. | <u>A</u> | 29. | <u>fact</u> | | |
| 5. | <u>D</u> | 30. | <u>opinion</u> | | |
| 6. | <u>A</u> | 31. | <u>fact</u> | | |
| 7. | <u>A</u> | 32. | <u>opinion</u> | | |
| 8. | <u>C</u> | 33. | <u>fact</u> | | |
| 9. | <u>B</u> | 34. | <u>fact</u> | | |
| 10. | <u>B</u> | 35. | <u>opinion</u> | | |
| 11. | <u>B</u> | 36. | <u>opinion</u> | | |
| 12. | <u>D</u> | 37. | <u>true</u> | | |
| 13. | <u>A</u> | 38. | <u>false</u> | | |
| 14. | <u>Would</u> | 39. | <u>true</u> | | |
| 15. | <u>Not</u> | 40. | <u>false</u> | | |
| 16. | <u>Not</u> | 41. | <u>true</u> | | |
| 17. | <u>Not</u> | 42. | <u>false</u> | | |
| 18. | <u>Would</u> | 43. | <u>false</u> | | |
| 19. | <u>Would</u> | 44. | <u>false</u> | | |
| 20. | <u>Not</u> | 45. | <u>true</u> | | |
| 21. | <u>Not</u> | 46. | <u>true</u> | | |
| 22. | <u>Not</u> | 47. | <u>declarative</u> | | |
| 23. | <u>Would</u> | 48. | <u>interrogative</u> | | |
| 24. | <u>Not</u> | 49. | <u>declarative</u> | | |
| 25. | <u>Would</u> | 50. | <u>declarative</u> | | |